

Verbal Vortex

Sahityika, the Literary Society

Proposal Details

Event Title	Verbal Vortex
Proposer's Name	Neeraja Cheboyina
Proposer's Student Email	Neeraja

Event Details

Event Domain	a) Literary b) Oratory
Event Type	Solo
Event Duration	Round 1 : 2 Hours 45 Minutes Round 2 : 2 Hours 30 Minutes Round 3 : 1 Hour
Event Prizes Description	Top performers will be awarded cash prizes and certificates of achievement in recognition of their creativity, linguistic skill, and persuasive communication across the rounds.

Team Details

Sr No	Name	Designation	Student Email	Contact Number
1.	Neeraja Cheboyina	Event Head	Neeraja	6301392734
2.	Anagha S	Deputy Head	Anagha S	8921756355
3.	Sayan Mazumder	Volunteer	25F2004497 SAYA...	9007672908
4.	Shakthy K	Volunteer	25F2007351 S...	9150683155
5.		Volunteer		

Event Scope

Target Participants and Skill Set Required

Target Participants: Students and Employees of IITM

Skill Set: **Verbal Vortex** is open to all those who are interested in language-based challenges and communication activities. Participants should possess strong vocabulary, creative thinking, problem solving ability and effective communication skills. Participants are to have spontaneity and confidently present their pitch ideas within tight time constraints. Participants are to navigate the challenge through immersive storytelling and persuasive speaking.

How does this event contribute to the Fest?

Verbal Vortex adds an interactive literary platform that encourages creativity, quick thinking, and participant engagement. Through activities such as word puzzles, storytelling and pitching, the event allows students to explore language, imagination and persuasive communications in a very witty and competitive environment. This provides an opportunity for the participants to showcase their vocabulary and public speaking skills. By combining the literary and oratory challenges, the event successfully creates an engaging space that complements literature and fosters healthy competition and audience engagement giving an enriching experience to the participants. This event encourages inclusive participation bringing it to diverse academic backgrounds and not just those interested in literary challenges only.

Proposer's Details

Any Experience Managing Events?

I have been actively involved in managing literary and cultural events through my work with the Sahityika Literary Society at IIT Madras. Over the past year, I have served as both an executive team member and, more recently, as the Head of the society's executive team. In these roles, I have contributed to the planning, coordination, hosting, and promotion of several literary events, ensuring their smooth execution and participant engagement.

Through these experiences, I have gained practical exposure to organizing event logistics, coordinating with team members, and managing different stages of event execution from ideation and planning to implementation. My involvement has also included supporting proposal preparation, collaborating with editorial and organizing teams, and ensuring clarity and coordination among different contributors.

In addition, at my offline college I have assisted in organizing technical and academic events, including hackathons and sessions conducted in collaboration with organizations such as ISRO and IEEE student chapters. These experiences have helped me develop organizational, communication, and coordination skills that are essential for managing events effectively.

Sahityika, the literary society of IITM BS, has conducted multiple creative literary events across different editions of Paradox since Paradox in Margazhi '23 through Paradox '24. These events have included poetry, storytelling, improvisation, LitJam, literary quizzes, and other language-inclusive activities. Through our experience in conducting such events and coordinating with external judges and faculty members from institutions like IIT Madras and Loyola College, the team has developed structured processes that support fair judging, inclusivity, and engaging event design. Being part of this ecosystem has given me valuable experience in organizing literary events collaboratively and responsibly.

Why do you think you are a suitable candidate to head this event?

My continued involvement with Sahityika has given me a clear understanding of the society's objectives, event formats, and the level of coordination required to execute literary events successfully. Over the past year, I have actively contributed to multiple initiatives and event activities within the society, which has helped me develop familiarity with the planning and management processes involved.

Serving as the Executive Head of the executive team has also given me the opportunity to coordinate with different team members, guide discussions around event planning, and ensure that responsibilities are distributed and carried out effectively. These experiences have strengthened my ability to communicate clearly, organize tasks, and maintain coordination within a team.

Additionally, my interest in literary activities and participation in similar events allows me to understand what makes an event engaging for participants. I hope to use this perspective, along with the experience gained from working with the Sahityika team, to ensure that the event is organized in a structured, inclusive, and enjoyable manner for everyone involved.

Event Description

Overview

Verbal Vortex presents a creative platform that combines language and communication through a series of interactive challenges that tests the vocab, quick thinking and persuasive ability of the participants. Each round focuses on the unique aspects of linguistics.

The event begins with Round 1: **Wordzilla**, where participants go through fast paced word challenges and test their quick thinking, language and diction. They are to go through the 3 phases in it: **jumbled words, who am i and crossword puzzle** where participants can only attempt once under time constraints, making speed and accuracy crucial.

The shortlisted participants shall proceed to the second round titled **Letter by Letter**, where participants must chain together words in alphabetical order to create stories. The rigid constraint brings out the roots of improvisation, creativity and linguistic skills, leading to small stories that have the constrained rhythm and show quick thinking and alphabetical accuracy. They will be evaluated on how far they can take the story and how well said story is constructed, focusing on coherence, ability and depth.

The shortlisted participants proceed to the final round titled **Pitch-a-Rama**, taken inspiration from Elevator Pitching, each participant is provided with a unique prompt object and are to pitch it to the judges and audience, a true test of persuasive wordplay and quick thinking under time pressure. They will be evaluated on how well they present themselves, body language, persuasiveness and confidence, closing the event on a high-speed competitive yet entertaining note.

A brief description of the event is as follows:

- **Round 1: Wordzilla**

- Platform: Online (Google Meet)
- No. of Participants: 100
- Time Breakdown: 1 min 30 sec per participant
- Total Time: $1.5 \times 100 = 150$ minutes = 2 hour 30 minutes + 15 min
- Buffer = 2 Hours 45 Minutes (Approximately)
- Participants Qualifying for the next round: 50% of the total

- **Round 2:- Letter by Letter**

- Platform: Offline
- No. of Participants: 50
- Time Breakdown: 3 minutes
- Total Time: $3 \times 50 = 150$ minutes = 2 hour 30 minutes + 15 min
- Buffer = 2 Hours 45 Minutes (Approximately)
- Participants Qualifying for the next round: 50% of the total

- **Round 3:- Pitch-a-Rama**

- Platform: Offline
- No. of Participants: 25
- Time Breakdown: 4min
- Total Time: $4 \times 25 = 100$ minutes = 1 hour 40 mins + 20 min
- Buffer = 2 hours

Objective

This event puts forward a set of fun, unique and engaging fast-paced word challenges that hopes to enhance the participants' quick problem solving skills, language and vocab. The event aims to encourage participants to think critically and recognize patterns in language. It also provides a space to share linguistic creativity while creating a competitive learning experience as the event serves both as entertainment and a locus for creative expression. It also encourages mental agility and attention to detail given the nature of the rounds within.

Selection Process

- **Criteria for Selection:**

Participants will be evaluated based on their **quick thinking, articulation, linguistic creativity, ability to solve under time constraints, problem solving ability and adaptability**. Each round focuses on different aspects, and participants will be shortlisted based on their overall performance.

- For the **Preliminary Round (Wordzilla)**, online performances will be evaluated on the following
 - Accuracy in quick problem solving.
 - Vocabulary strength and language proficiency.
 - Speed and precision while working under time constraints.
- For the **Semi-Finals (Letter by Letter)**, offline performances will be evaluated on the following:
 - Linguistic creativity
 - Length of story
 - Coherence and flow of story
- For the **Finals (Pitch-A-Rama)** offline performances will be evaluated on the following:
 - Persuasiveness and originality of the pitch
 - Clarity and communication skills
 - Performative creativity and ability to improvise

All evaluations will be conducted with **external judges with relevant expertise in English literature, an author, storytelling and creative storytelling** according to fest guidelines.

- **Steps undertaken while selecting participants**

- **Preliminary Round – Wordzilla**

All registered participants compete in this round. Based on their accuracy and sharpness in solving these challenges within the stipulated time, the top performing candidates will be shortlisted to move on to the next round

- **Semi-Final Round – Letter by Letter**
The shortlisted participants are to take part in an alphabetical storytelling challenge. Participants who showcase creativity, precise sequencing and coherent formation of sentences will be selected for the final round.
- **Final Round – Pitch-A-Rama**
The finalists will present their elevator pitches based on the given prompts. Participants are to be evaluated on their persuasiveness, creativity and communication skill. The best overall performance will determine the winners.

Event Flow and Timeline

The event will be conducted in a three-round format: Preliminary -> Semi-Final-> Final, with each round designed to evaluate different aspects of linguistic creativity, vocabulary, communication skills and storytelling ability such as creative writing, verbal narration, and improvisational thinking.

The final schedule and timings will be provided upon selection of the event, based on slot availability.

- **Round 1- Wordzilla (Preliminary Round)**
 - **Format:** Online narrative challenge
 - **Time required:** 2 hours 45 minutes(Including hosting + Judge's Words and Buffer)
 - **Day of Event:** TBD
 - **Tentative Time of the Event:** 6:00 - 8:45 PM
 - **Task:** Participants take on a series of phase-gates challenges such as Jumbled Words, "Who Am I?" and Crosswords.
 - **Evaluation:** External judges evaluate performance across all challenges, creativity, time needed and total score of correctness.
 - **Selection:** 50% of initial participants advance to the Semi-Finals.
- **Round 2- Letter by Letter (Semi-Finals)**
 - **Format:** Offline - storytelling challenge.
 - **Time required:** 2 Hours 30 Minutes(Including hosting + Judge's Words and Buffer)
 - **Day of Event:** Day two of the Paradox
 - **Tentative Time of the Event:** 3:30 - 5:00 PM
 - **Task:** Craft a story wherein each word's initial letter follows the English alphabet.
 - **Evaluation:** External judges evaluate based on length of story, coherence, creativity, and adherence to the rule .
 - **Selection:** 50% of participants advance to the Final Round.
- **Round 3- Pitch-a-Rama (Finals)**
 - **Format:** Offline - persuasive pitching challenge.
 - **Time required:** 1 Hour(Including hosting + Judge's Words and Buffer)
 - **Day of Event:** Day three of the Paradox

- **Tentative Time of the Event: 5:00 - 6:00 PM**
- **Task:** Perform a persuasive elevator pitch on the provided prompt.
- **Evaluation:** External judges review the performance based on creativity, character consistency, immersive reactions, emotional accuracy and dramatisation.
- **Outcome:** Judges evaluate individual contributions to determine the **Winner and 1st Runner-Up, 2nd Runner-Up**.

Event Facilities & Requirements

- **Functional Requirements (FR)**
 - **Preliminary Round – Wordzilla**
 - The registration form for the event on the official Paradox website.
 - Capability to host, direct and engage in an Online Event for the round
 - Timely sharing of the registration data
 - **Semi-Final Round – Letter by Letter**
 - **Microphone and basic audio setup** for the participants and host speaking on the stage
 - **Host / Moderator** to guide and enforce the round and felicity of the event.
 - **Timer / timekeeping support** to ensure each participant stays within the allotted time
 - Judging sheets for evaluating participants' contribution during the storytelling.
 - **Final Round – Pitch-a-Rama**
 - **Microphone setup** for the finalists
 - **Host / Moderator** to guide and enforce the round **and** declare the emotion shift moment.
 - **Presentation slides / display screen** for the prompts.
 - **Timer support** to regulate the round duration
 - Judging sheets for evaluating participants' contribution during the storytelling.

Event Facilities & Requirements

- **Preliminary Round – Wordzilla**
 - No physical venue required, as this round will be conducted through **online performance**.
- **Semi- Final Round – Letter by Letter**
 - **A small stage / room or presentation area** where participants can perform their characters and speak on the given topic.
 - **Seating space and water facilities for participants, judges, and audience members**.
 - **Audio setup** including microphone(s) and speakers.
- **Final Round – Pitch-a-Rama**
 - **Same setup used for the semi-final round**.

Event Prizes & Judgement Criteria

Proposed Prizes

The event will recognize outstanding performance, dramatisation, pragmatism and talent across the round. The proposed prize structure is as follows:

- **Winner** – Cash Prize, Certificate of Achievement.
- **1st Runner-Up** – Cash Prize, Certificate of Achievement.
- **2nd Runner-Up** – Cash Prize, Certificate of Achievement.
- **Special Mention(Optional)** – Certificate of Merit for notable creativity or performance

Note: The final prize amounts will be determined in consultation with the Paradox Organising Team, in accordance with fest guidelines.

Judgement Criteria

Participants will be evaluated by **judges with relevant expertise in literature, performative arts, storytelling, creative storytelling and discourse**, in accordance to Paradox guidelines.

- **Preliminary Round – Wordzilla**

Evaluation will focus on the pragmatism in navigating the dilemma provided:

- Accuracy in quick problem solving.
- Vocabulary strength and language proficiency.
- Speed and precision while working under time constraints.

- **Semi-Final Round – Letter by Letter**

Evaluation will focus on storytelling ability under constraints:

- Linguistic creativity
- Length of story
- Coherence and flow of story

- **Final Round – Pitch-a-Rama**

Evaluation will focus on improvisational storytelling and narrative contribution:

- Persuasiveness and originality of the pitch
- Clarity and communication skills
- Performative creativity and ability to improvise

Estimated Budget

The estimated budget for the event covers prize distribution and small recognition items for the winners. The tentative budget breakdown is as follows:

- **Winner**
 - **Cash Prize: ₹3000**
 - Certificate of Achievement
- **1st Runner-Up**
 - **Cash Prize: ₹2000**
 - Certificate of Achievement
- **2nd Runner-Up**
 - **Cash Prize: ₹1000**
 - Certificate of Achievement
- **Special Mention (Optional)**
 - Certificate of Merit

Total Estimated Budget: ₹6000(Approx)

Note: The final prize amounts and rewards are subject to approval from the Paradox Cultural Core Team and Finance Team in accordance with fest guidelines.

Engagement Strategy

1. **All rounds** are created to test the quick-wittedness of participants and their ability to formlessly adapt to and work under both time pressure and unique constraints. These very challenges create an ecosystem of entertainment, adrenaline and intensity, bringing in and keeping them hooked, participant by participant, round by round. It keeps the participants engaged relentlessly with the diverse trials presented by each round, where their skills will be put on display and to the test. The **event** is designed to enrich the fest's quality through its engaging competitive atmosphere and entertain the audience through that very medium.
2. The event will be promoted through **official Paradox communication channels, approved promotional posters, and announcements shared across student communities within the IITM BS ecosystem**. Additionally, promotional updates and reminders will be circulated through the proposing **society's communication channels, mailing lists, and community platforms** (in accordance with communication guidelines) to encourage participation and maintain engagement.

Guests and Judges

A judge will be selected from outside the IITM community. Ideally, the judge will be a literature scholar, author, storytelling professional or narrative specialist with experience in narrative creation, literary and logical evaluation, or pragmatic approaches. The judge shall possess a strong understanding of character consistency, creative expression, and improvisational narrative techniques, enabling them to fairly evaluate participants across both written and spoken rounds of the event.

"Only societies and individuals can submit a proposal."

*****Submission of the Proposal does not guarantee the Acceptance of the Event. Please refrain from contacting culturals about updates regarding acceptance/rejection. We shall revert back and let you know ASAP*****